

How do I install WordPress in a different language?

An important part of using your website has the option to choose your preferred language on its interface. Otherwise, you may need to adapt certain parts of the site like pricing or other content (like terms and conditions) that are not language specific.

For example, if your website is bilingual, but you only speak one language, then it's best to go with this language as your “preferable” one. Users can still modify the content to their preference or needs by translating it on their end.

There are several ways to translate a web page or whole website into another language. We will cover some basic methods below, along with the advantages and disadvantages of each.

WordPress multi-language without plugin

It is very easy to set up another language on your website by copying and pasting some HTML code into your theme or template file.

There are two ways to do this. The first way is the easiest, but it only allows for one other language after you have installed it. You will need to open the wp-config.php file using your favorite text editor. Then find the line that reads “LANGUAGE” and replace everything inside the double quotes with the country code of your second language.

Then save the file and restart your web server.

The second method requires you to install a plugin called Polylang. This plugin adds an extra field to your login page where you can enter the language and number as well as the region (if applicable).

You must then manually update the language setting in their respective files to allow others to also use your site with different languages.

Since WordPress 4.1, you can already change the language of your website from the WordPress dashboard, as well as install new languages. There is no need to modify the WPLANG variable in the wp-config.php file, which has disappeared. All you have to do is go to Settings > General > Site language (at the bottom) and select the language or install a new one (no need to upload to and move files to your language folder anymore).

Note: if you are using any translation plugin (WPML, Polylang, qTranslate, Zanto, Multisite Language Switcher, etc.) you may need to change the language option in the plugin itself as well. You may also need to disable these plugins before changing the language option in the WordPress admin panel.

Two issues that can only arise in WordPress 4.0 versions: